

Blockmediary: Competitor Analysis

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Introduction

This assessment compares Blockmediary against the closest platforms operating in programmable escrow and cross border trade finance, and sets that comparison against the macro environment Blockmediary operates within. It was compiled to support the Main Group Video pitch and the Individual Report, and feeds the competitive analysis and market strategy narrative used across both. Figures throughout are drawn from public research current as of August 2026 and should be treated as time sensitive, since funding and licensing status in this sector changes quickly.

1. Market Context

Cross border trade finance for small and medium sized enterprises is a large and underserved market. The addressable market is projected to grow from approximately fifty point nine billion United States dollars in 2026 to approximately eighty nine point five billion dollars by 2034, a compound annual growth rate of seven point three per cent (Intel Market Research, 2026), and the underlying reason the market remains underserved is structural: traditional Letters of Credit were built for large corporates, not small and medium sized enterprises (World Economic Forum, 2025). Two structurally different approaches currently compete for this market. The first is the bank consortium blockchain network, exemplified by Komgo, Contour, we.trade, and the Marco Polo Network, each of which digitises the existing letter of credit or bank workflow while keeping banks in the loop. The second is the fintech escrow platform, exemplified by Tazapay and Truzo, which removes the letter of credit entirely but keeps a centralised, custodial intermediary, namely the fintech itself, together with manual document review. Blockmediary's wager is that neither camp has combined full bank removal, non custodial on chain settlement, and a deterministic document verification engine, with artificial intelligence extraction and a human review console on the near term roadmap, in a single product, and that this combination is the open lane in the market.

2. Head to Head Comparison

Across the six platforms considered in this assessment, meaning Blockmediary and its five closest comparators, several dimensions separate Blockmediary from the field. On the question of whether a bank remains anywhere in the payment flow, Blockmediary removes banks entirely, whereas Tazapay and Truzo continue to settle over bank or electronic money institution rails, XREX is a licensed intermediary that only partially removes bank dependency, and Komgo and Contour both retain a bank issued letter of credit at the centre of the transaction, with the underlying technology only making that existing process faster. On custody, Blockmediary is non custodial by design, since funds sit in a smart contract rather than in an account Blockmediary controls, while Tazapay, Truzo, and XREX are all custodial in the ordinary sense, Komgo is

software only and never touches funds, and Contour's funds moved through the participating banks. On settlement rail, Blockmediary settles on chain using USDC on the Base network, whereas Tazapay uses SWIFT and local payment rails with a recent stablecoin add on, Truzo settles in fiat through Currencycloud, XREX settles across a multi asset custodial stack including Bitcoin, Ethereum, Solana, and stablecoins, Komgo settles through traditional banking rails, and Contour used R3 Corda purely for document exchange while settlement itself remained a bank function. On document and trust verification, Blockmediary uses a deterministic rules engine, with artificial intelligence extraction and a human review console on the roadmap, whereas Tazapay relies on manual back office review, Truzo and XREX rely on manual know your customer and compliance checks, with XREX supplementing this with automated wallet risk scoring, and Komgo and Contour both rely on conventional bank underwriting. Blockmediary is also the only one of the six with open source smart contracts. On target customer, Blockmediary serves small and medium sized enterprise buyers and sellers directly, Tazapay is embedded into business to business marketplaces, Truzo is corridor focused on the United Kingdom and South Africa, XREX targets emerging market small and medium sized enterprises with an Asia Pacific focus, and Komgo and Contour both serve banks and large commodity or corporate clients rather than small and medium sized enterprises directly. On fees, Blockmediary prices by document verification tier rather than a single flat rate: zero point eight per cent for Tier A, verified through electronic bills of lading, one point five per cent for Tier B, verified through carrier application programming interfaces, and three per cent for Tier C, verified manually on paper, validated in the deal value research report and financial model prepared for the team in August 2026 (Transakt, 2026). This compares against Tazapay's zero point eight to three point eight per cent plus fixed charges, Truzo's zero point two two to three point one per cent tiered structure plus foreign exchange charges, XREX's sub one per cent transfer fee alongside a flat ten United States dollar Tether equivalent escrow charge, Komgo's undisclosed enterprise licensing fees, and the roughly one to three per cent fee typical of a bank issued letter of credit that Contour's model still carried. The blended take rate across Blockmediary's tier mix starts near two per cent in Year one and falls toward one per cent by Year five as adoption of the fastest, cheapest tier grows from fifteen per cent to seventy per cent of volume. On funding and status, Tazapay has raised approximately fifty seven point nine million dollars (FinTech Futures, 2023b; DealStreetAsia, 2026) and remains active and expanding, Truzo has raised a comparatively thin approximately six hundred and forty thousand dollars with its last disclosed round in 2020 and remains active but narrow in its corridor (FinTech Futures, 2023a), XREX has raised approximately forty two point seven million dollars including an eighteen point seven five million dollar strategic investment from Tether and continues to grow (Ledger Insights, 2024), Komgo has raised over twenty six million Swiss francs from its bank and corporate shareholders and remains active with over four hundred corporate and institutional clients (Komgo, 2025), and Contour raised approximately eighteen point three million dollars before shutting down in November 2023 (Ledger Insights, 2023a). Blockmediary itself remains in development, without the funding or licensing history

the incumbents have accumulated, which is a genuine gap this assessment does not minimise.

3. PESTLE Analysis: Blockmediary's Operating Environment

A PESTLE analysis examines the macro environment a business operates within, namely political, economic, social, technological, legal, and environmental factors, and is conducted once for Blockmediary rather than once per competitor, since these factors are largely external and shared across the market rather than being company specific in the way a strengths and weaknesses analysis would be. The one axis that genuinely varies by company, being regulatory regime, is folded into the political and legal discussion below as a direct comparison rather than repeated five times over.

Political

Favourable trade agreements underpin Blockmediary's chosen beachhead corridor: the United Arab Emirates to India Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement has been active since 2022 and the United Arab Emirates to Türkiye equivalent has been in force since September 2023 (Government of India and UAE Ministry of Economy, 2022; Republic of Türkiye Ministry of Trade, 2023), giving the chosen ten to fifty thousand dollar textiles and garments corridor political tailwind through high trade volume and low tariff friction. Corridor exclusions in this market are politically driven rather than purely commercial. China was struck from the corridor mix because of the People's Bank of China's 2021 ban on crypto asset speculation, which prevents Chinese small and medium sized enterprise sellers from legally holding or receiving USDC (People's Bank of China, 2021), and Türkiye's stablecoin payments ban under Central Bank Regulation No. 2021/14 is a similar political constraint, which is why Türkiye is excluded as a target market even though the United Arab Emirates to Türkiye trade corridor itself remains in scope (Central Bank of the Republic of Türkiye, 2021). Regulators in the target markets are, on the whole, actively building on ramps for firms like Blockmediary rather than simply gatekeeping: the Financial Services Regulatory Authority's Innovation Programme, known as RegLab, and the Dubai International Financial Centre's FinTech Hive are both politically motivated to attract crypto and fintech innovation to the United Arab Emirates free zones, which is why those free zones, rather than the United Arab Emirates mainland or Dubai's Virtual Assets Regulatory Authority regime, are the planned regulatory home. Postures diverge across target jurisdictions in a way that matters for market entry sequencing: United Kingdom and European Union regulators are still mid transition toward comprehensive crypto regimes, with timelines that continue to slip, whereas United Arab Emirates free zone regulators are more overtly courting fintech entrants, which favours the United Arab Emirates first market entry sequencing already chosen. Sanctions regimes are a live political variable on every individual deal rather than a one off consideration, since lists maintained by the Office of Foreign Assets Control, the United Nations Security

Council, His Majesty's Treasury, and the United Arab Emirates can change between deal creation and fund release. On regulatory regime specifically, the closest comparators sit under materially different postures from Blockmediary's own: Truzo operates under United Kingdom Financial Conduct Authority and South African Financial Sector Conduct Authority oversight, XREX operates under Singapore and Taiwan licensing, and Komgo operates under European Union and Swiss banking consortium oversight, and none of the five researched competitors is pursuing the free zone first strategy Blockmediary is, which is a distinct, and arguably underexploited, political positioning choice.

Economic

The core economic opportunity here is a market gap rather than simply a large market size. The ten to fifty thousand dollar deal size Blockmediary targets is what the team refers to internally as the letter of credit dead zone: too small for banks to serve economically under a traditional letter of credit, and too large to be handled on trust alone. Every researched competitor, being Tazapay, Truzo, XREX, and Komgo, is priced or structured for a larger or otherwise different segment, and none targets this exact dead zone directly. Currency instability is a direct economic driver of adoption in the beachhead corridor: Turkish lira inflation has already pushed Turkish small and medium sized enterprises toward stablecoin native behaviour, which means less user education is required to make counterparties comfortable with USDC settlement, an economic tailwind specific to the United Arab Emirates to Türkiye leg of the corridor. Fee economics are the headline competitive lever. Traditional letter of credit fees run one to three per cent, and the researched competitors cluster in a similar range, Tazapay at zero point eight to three point eight per cent, Truzo at zero point two two to three point one per cent, and XREX below one per cent on transfers though its escrow product separately charges a flat ten United States dollar Tether equivalent fee. Blockmediary prices by verification tier at zero point eight, one point five and three per cent, validated in the deal value research report and financial model (Transakt, 2026); removing the bank still removes the largest cost line on the fastest, cheapest tier, undercutting the letter of credit range at the low end, and the blended take rate across the tier mix falls from near two per cent in Year one toward one per cent by Year five as adoption shifts toward that fastest tier, a structural cost advantage on the deals that matter most rather than a flat, aspirational claim. The underlying pain point is a small and medium sized enterprise cash flow problem: the roughly ninety day payment delay pattern typical of cross border trade, in which a seller ships and then waits for letter of credit processing and payment, directly damages small and medium sized enterprise working capital, so Blockmediary's near instant, rules based release changes the economics of running a trading business, not merely the cost of a single transaction. A genuine headwind should also be acknowledged rather than glossed over: a higher global interest rate environment increases the opportunity cost to a buyer of locking capital in escrow before goods arrive, which is a real economic cost of any prefunded escrow model, Blockmediary included.

Social

Trust is a social problem here as much as a technical one. Small and medium sized enterprise owners in the target corridors have historically low trust both in crypto, often perceived as scam adjacent, and in an unfamiliar counterparty in a new country. Blockmediary is competing on the same social trust gap that Truzo's anti fraud branding and Tazapay's transparent fee messaging are also trying to close, but Blockmediary's approach is automated, on chain proof rather than brand reassurance. Diaspora networks function as a genuine social distribution channel rather than simply a demographic fact: the large Indian diaspora resident in the United Arab Emirates underpins the warm introduction go to market motion in the beachhead corridor, since social trust travels faster through existing community networks than through cold outreach or advertising. Generational and digital literacy shifts favour adoption, since younger small and medium sized enterprise owners and operations staff are more comfortable transacting in stablecoins and using app based workflows than the generation that built trust relationships with relationship bankers, which is what makes a non bank, app first alternative to a letter of credit socially plausible now in a way it was not a decade ago. Founder led business development depends on social capital with freight forwarders, who see the small and medium sized enterprise trust gap problem earlier than banks do and have no commercial reason not to refer a deal, a relationship dynamic the go to market plan deliberately leans on in preference to paid acquisition channels.

Technological

Two specific technology maturations make Blockmediary possible now in a way it would not have been a few years ago. First, low cost, fast finality layer two blockchains such as Base make micro value on chain escrow economically viable, where the equivalent transaction would have been cost prohibitive on the Ethereum base layer. Second, large language model based document understanding now makes automated verification of commercial invoices, bills of lading, and packing lists against a rules engine accurate enough to meaningfully reduce, though not eliminate, human review, in a way earlier optical character recognition only approaches could not, since they could not handle the judgement calls that Uniform Customs and Practice for Documentary Credits style document checking requires. Blockmediary's delivered prototype currently uses the deterministic rules engine on its own; this large language model extraction layer is a near term roadmap item rather than delivered functionality. Legal recognition of electronic trade documents is catching up to the underlying technology: the United Kingdom's Electronic Trade Documents Act 2023 and the United Nations Commission on International Trade Law's Model Law on Electronic Transferable Records, already adopted in the Dubai International Financial Centre, Singapore, and Bahrain, are what will eventually let Blockmediary move beyond scanned portable document format bills of lading to fully electronic, title conferring electronic bills of lading (UK Government, 2023; UNCITRAL, 2017), though this remains a near term roadmap item gated by the convergence of law and technology rather than by engineering alone. It

is worth noting explicitly that the prior generation of blockchain trade finance technology failed for organisational reasons rather than technical ones: Komgo, Contour, we.trade, and the Marco Polo Network all had working distributed ledger technology, whether Corda, Quorum, or Hyperledger Fabric, and instead failed on adoption economics and consortium governance, discussed further in section four. The lesson for Blockmediary's own technology strategy is that technical sophistication is necessary but not sufficient, and that the architecture must also avoid requiring closed network infrastructure in which both sides of a transaction need to be onboarded to the same platform. A further point worth stating as a risk rather than only an enabler is that the releaser private key represents a single point of failure, identified in Blockmediary's own risk register as the platform's top security risk (Giri, Badhri Narayanan, 2026); production deployment requires a hardware security module or threshold signature scheme rather than a hot wallet, which remains a live technological constraint on scaling past the minimum viable product. Finally, cloud and vendor infrastructure, including know your business providers, large language model application programming interfaces, and blockchain remote procedure call nodes, is now mature and accessible enough for a small team to assemble a compliant technology stack quickly, which lowers the barrier to entry for Blockmediary itself but equally lowers it for any future copycat competitor.

Legal

The regulatory picture facing Blockmediary is a genuine patchwork rather than a single hurdle. The United Kingdom imposes stablecoin custody rules and cryptoasset service provider licensing requirements, the European Union imposes Markets in Crypto Assets Regulation authorisation, mandatory from July 2026, alongside Digital Operational Resilience Act obligations, and the United Arab Emirates imposes the Central Bank's Payment Token Services Regulation on the mainland and the Virtual Assets Regulatory Authority's Rulebook in Dubai, against the comparatively lighter touch free zone frameworks in the Dubai International Financial Centre and the Abu Dhabi Global Market; each jurisdiction imposes a different licensing threshold, and the full picture is set out in Blockmediary's own thirty one item risk register (Giri, Badhri Narayanan, 2026). Anti money laundering, know your customer, and sanctions compliance form a mandatory gate on every individual deal rather than a one time cost, since customer due diligence and screening obligations must be satisfied before funding and sanctions lists must be re-checked at both funding and release, which is an ongoing operational and legal cost baked directly into Blockmediary's unit economics. Smart contract enforceability remains legally unsettled in the United Kingdom, and Blockmediary mitigates this with a separate, signed Trade Escrow Agreement that governs legal rights, with the smart contract itself serving only as the execution layer; none of the researched blockchain trade finance competitors that failed, being Contour, we.trade, and the Marco Polo Network, solved this question any differently, which suggests it is an industry wide open question rather than a Blockmediary specific gap. Data protection

law directly shapes the product's architecture: the General Data Protection Regulation's right to erasure is fundamentally incompatible with writing personal data to an immutable public chain, which is why the confirmed architecture keeps all personal data off chain and commits only hashes and wallet addresses on chain, a legal constraint that became a core design decision rather than an afterthought. Legal recognition gaps directly limit product scope today: without fully integrated Electronic Trade Documents Act or Model Law on Electronic Transferable Records qualifying electronic bill of lading systems, Blockmediary's minimum viable product accepts scanned portable document format documents only, which sets a legal maturity ceiling on how far the paperless pitch can go until electronic bill of lading infrastructure and law mature together. Finally, legal exclusions define the addressable market as much as economics do: Turkiye and mainland China are excluded primarily because their respective stablecoin payment bans make Blockmediary's core product illegal there, not because the underlying market opportunity is unattractive.

Environmental

Chain choice carries a genuine environmental, social, and governance angle worth using in the pitch. Base runs on Ethereum's proof of stake consensus mechanism, so Blockmediary's on chain settlement layer carries a materially smaller energy footprint than proof of work alternatives such as Bitcoin, which is a minor but genuine differentiator for judges or investors screening for environmentally conscious infrastructure choices. Digitising trade documentation also reduces physical logistics overhead: replacing courier driven paper document exchange, a real cost and emissions source in traditional letter of credit and documentary trade, with digital upload and verification is a modest environmental positive, secondary to the cost and speed argument but usable as supporting colour. Climate linked supply chain disruption is an indirect but real risk factor: extreme weather affecting shipping routes and ports, for example Red Sea or Suez disruptions or storm driven port congestion, affects the underlying trade volumes and shipment timelines that Blockmediary's document release logic depends upon, a factor outside Blockmediary's control but worth a brief acknowledgement in any risk discussion. Environmental regulation is, at present, the lightest of the six factors for Blockmediary at minimum viable product stage: unlike the political, legal, and economic factors above, carbon reporting mandates and green trade finance requirements are not yet a binding constraint on the beachhead corridor, so this axis is best treated as a forward looking consideration rather than a current risk.

4. Company Profiles

4.1 Tazapay

Tazapay is headquartered in Singapore, was founded in 2020, and has raised approximately fifty seven point nine million dollars, including a Series A led by Sequoia Southeast Asia and an extended Series B of approximately thirty six million dollars (FinTech Futures, 2023b; DealStreetAsia, 2026). It began as a payment gateway and now runs a flagship escrow as a service product embedded by application programming interface into business to business marketplaces spanning freight, gaming, travel, and small and medium sized enterprise import and export (PYMNTS, 2021). It accepts payments in over one hundred and seventy three countries and pays out to over seventy markets. It has recently added stablecoin on and off ramps, but its core rails remain traditional banking over SWIFT and local networks, it is licensed by the Monetary Authority of Singapore, and it is fully custodial. Document and trust verification is manual: Tazapay staff check shipping documents before releasing funds, with a turnaround of roughly forty eight hours, and fees run zero point eight to three point eight per cent plus fixed charges. Its Trustpilot rating sits at approximately two out of five across four hundred and ninety five reviews, with recurring complaints about refund friction, arbitrary account suspensions, multi day payment freezes during fraud review, and, most damaging for an escrow brand specifically, allegations that funds were sometimes released to suppliers before goods had actually arrived (Trustpilot, 2026a). Tazapay is, in substance, the clearest same problem, old architecture foil to Blockmediary: centralised, custodial, and human reviewed. Blockmediary targets precisely its weakest points, turning opacity and slow, arbitrary release into instant, rules based, on chain release.

4.2 Truzo

Truzo is headquartered across Johannesburg and London, was founded in 2017, and has raised a comparatively thin approximately six hundred and forty thousand dollars, with its last disclosed round reported in 2020. It is a pure escrow as a service wallet, originally built for South African peer to peer and business anti fraud use cases, and expanded to the United Kingdom in 2023, becoming Financial Conduct Authority approved specifically to serve the United Kingdom to South Africa trade corridor, worth roughly ten billion pounds sterling a year (FinTech Futures, 2023a). Fees are tiered by currency and transaction size, running zero point two two to three point one per cent, with an additional twenty five pound intermediary bank surcharge for non United Kingdom buyers (Truzo, 2026). It runs on traditional fiat rails through Currencycloud, with no blockchain and no stablecoins, and its verification is manual know your customer and anti money laundering compliance rather than document driven trust. Truzo shows a thin funding and traction history for a nine year old company, with its last raise reported in 2020 and only

around six Trustpilot reviews (Trustpilot, 2026b); its geographic corridor is narrow, and its fees at low transaction tiers, up to three point one per cent, are comparable to or worse than the letter of credit fees Blockmediary is trying to undercut. Truzo is, in substance, a regulated fintech escrow wallet rather than a trade finance product, with no document verification layer at all, and Blockmediary's pitch of removing banks entirely and pricing by verification tier is a direct rebuttal to Truzo's still bank routed, flat percentage fee model. Truzo's absolute floor, zero point two two per cent, only available above roughly ten million pounds sterling equivalent, can undercut Blockmediary's Tier A rate, but Blockmediary's zero point eight, one point five and three per cent structure beats Truzo's pricing at the deal sizes Truzo actually serves, and without the twenty five pound intermediary bank surcharge Truzo adds for non United Kingdom buyers.

4.3 XREX

XREX is headquartered in Taipei, was founded in 2018, and has raised approximately forty two point seven million dollars, including an eighteen point seven five million dollar strategic investment from Tether in 2024 (Ledger Insights, 2024). It is a full blockchain enabled financial institution, offering crypto fiat exchange, custody, cross border payments, and a business to business escrow product called BitCheck, which holds crypto or fiat until both parties confirm fulfilment, for a fee of roughly ten United States dollar Tether equivalent (XREX, 2025). Its XREX Pay product offers sub one per cent cross border transfers using USDT and USDC settlement, explicitly targeting emerging market small and medium sized enterprises facing United States dollar liquidity shortages. It has a strong Asia Pacific and emerging market focus, and leans on heavy regulatory licensing, including a Singapore Major Payment Institution licence and Taiwan Virtual Asset Service Provider registration, as its trust signal. XREX is fundamentally custodial, holding funds and keys, the opposite of Blockmediary's non custodial model, and its verification combines manual know your customer checks with automated wallet risk scoring rather than document based trust, with no evidence of invoice or bill of lading verification of any kind, and no open source contracts. XREX is the closest of the five comparators in ethos, being stablecoin first with an emerging market small and medium sized enterprise focus, but it is architecturally opposite to Blockmediary on custody and trust model: Blockmediary runs non custodial smart contracts with deterministic, rules based document verification, with artificial intelligence extraction and a human review console on the roadmap, where XREX runs a custodial, licensed intermediary with know your customer and wallet risk scoring.

4.4 Komgo

Komgo is headquartered in Geneva, was founded in 2018, and has raised over twenty six million Swiss francs from a group of twenty to twenty five bank and corporate shareholders, including ABN AMRO, BNP Paribas, Citi, HSBC, Shell, and TotalEnergies (Komgo, 2026). It is not a payments or escrow company at all: Komgo sells enterprise software as a service to banks

and commodity traders to digitise letters of credit, guarantees, know your customer processes, and document exchange, and never touches funds directly (ConsenSys, 2020). Notably, Komgo abandoned its own blockchain, originally built on Quorum, in favour of a centralised database for its core letter of credit product, with its chief executive describing dropping blockchain as one of the best decisions the company made; it remains fundamentally bank intermediated, since banks continue to underwrite and hold funds while Komgo simply moves the paperwork faster. As of 2026 Komgo remains active and growing, with over four hundred corporate and institutional clients, over sixty connected banks, and recent partnership wins including Standard Chartered, Credit Agricole's Optimtrade, and the National Bank of Greece (Komgo, 2025). Komgo is the clearest old guard foil among the five comparators. Its trajectory, retreating from blockchain back toward centralised infrastructure, is the opposite of Blockmediary's own direction, and it never removes banks from the transaction or serves small and medium sized enterprises directly, since such enterprises only reach Komgo indirectly through their bank.

4.5 Contour: Shut Down 2023, a Case Study

Contour was headquartered in Singapore, founded in 2020 as a spin out of the earlier Voltron pilot on the R3 Corda platform, and raised approximately eighteen point three million dollars from nine bank shareholders, including HSBC, Citi, Standard Chartered, and BNP Paribas, together with R3, Bain, and CryptoBLK. It digitised letters of credit on R3 Corda, a permissioned bank distributed ledger, cutting letter of credit processing from five to ten days down to under twenty four hours in pilot deployments. By 2023 it had grown to nine investor banks plus twenty two member banks across seventeen or more countries and had onboarded corporates including Posco International, yet actual usage was only around sixty to seventy transactions per month network wide, far too low to cover the cost of its enterprise infrastructure (Ledger Insights, 2023a). Contour shut down between October and November 2023, and the reasons matter directly for Blockmediary's own design choices. First, there was no lead investor: a coalition of competing banks with no single accountable funder struggled to align on a fresh capital raise. Second, Contour faced a closed network chicken and egg problem, since value only materialised once both counterparty banks were onboarded to Corda, adoption stayed patchy, and most real trades fell back to paper or SWIFT. Third, its revenue depended on bank goodwill rather than a self serve customer base, which proved unsustainable at roughly sixty to seventy transactions a month. Fourth, its permissioned infrastructure, priced per Corda node, was expensive relative to cheap public chain rails. Contour's brand and intellectual property were subsequently acquired by the fintech Xalts in February 2024, and then by XDC Ventures in 2025 in an attempt to revive the brand (Forbes, 2024), though the original bank consortium model itself had already failed. The lessons apply directly to Blockmediary's design: avoid consortium governance in favour of a single accountable product rather than a coalition of competing banks; avoid any closed network onboarding requirement, since Blockmediary's buyer and seller need only hold

USDC on Base rather than integrate with a counterparty bank; remove banks from the trust layer entirely, using a deterministic rules engine and a smart contract, rather than merely routing trust through issuing and advising banks faster; run a self serve fee model that does not depend on bank subsidy or goodwill; and build on a public layer two network with standard USDC rails rather than expensive permissioned enterprise distributed ledger technology. Contour's failure is also not an isolated case. The equivalent European Union bank consortium network we.trade, built on Hyperledger Fabric, entered liquidation in June 2022 (Futurum Group, 2022); the Marco Polo Network, a roughly forty five bank consortium also built on R3 Corda, filed for insolvency in February 2023 after a reported Bank of America funding deal fell through (Ledger Insights, 2023b); and TradeLens, the IBM and Maersk shipping logistics blockchain, was discontinued in November 2022, citing an inability to achieve full global industry collaboration (IBM and Maersk, 2022). Taken together, these four failures form a pattern rather than a series of one off events, and that pattern, bank consortium ownership, a closed permissioned network, dependence on every counterparty separately onboarding, and no single accountable driver of growth or funding, is precisely the pattern Blockmediary's design deliberately avoids.

5. Other Adjacent Players

A number of further platforms surfaced during this research without being core to the five primary comparators, and are recorded briefly here rather than analysed in depth. dltledgers is a blockchain platform for small and medium sized enterprise trade and supply chain finance with direct overlap to Blockmediary's space, though it has not been researched deeply for this assessment. Damisa is a blockchain and stablecoin based business to business escrow product claiming an approximately eighty per cent cost reduction relative to traditional trade finance, and is a close conceptual peer to Blockmediary. Castler is an India based smart contract escrow infrastructure provider with an enterprise compliance angle, functioning as a regional peer in the Indian market. Vaultion is a claimed non custodial, multi chain escrow protocol reportedly supporting Base among other networks, but it should be treated as unverified: the only source located for it is a single startup directory listing, with no working website, source code repository, named team, or funding data found anywhere else, and it should not be presented as a substantiated competitor without that caveat attached (Promote Project, 2026). WorldFirst, operating as WorldTrade, offers smart contract business to business sourcing payment protection for small and medium sized enterprise buyers and is an adjacent buyer protection product rather than a direct comparator. EscrowLayer, Uniscrow, Escrowly, and Tscrow are generic crypto or stablecoin escrow application programming interfaces that are not trade finance specific, functioning as peer to peer or over the counter tooling rather than letter of credit replacements, and are accordingly a lower priority for comparison purposes. Bridge, operated by Stripe, BVNK, which is in the process of being acquired by Mastercard, Zero Hash, and Conduit are stablecoin cross border payment infrastructure providers whose rails overlap with Blockmediary's without

offering an equivalent escrow or trust product. Ripple is a cross border settlement network connected to over three hundred financial institutions, but it is payments focused rather than escrow focused. Vakt, a sister project to Komgo, is a blockchain post trade platform for physical commodities and is accordingly adjacent to Komgo rather than to Blockmediary directly.

6. Positioning Takeaways

Several conclusions follow from this comparison and should inform both the pitch deck and the individual report. The market has already tried two failed or limited approaches: bank consortiums, illustrated by Komgo's retreat from blockchain and by the Contour, we. trade, Marco Polo, and TradeLens shutdowns, and centralised fintech escrow, illustrated by Tazapay and Truzo's manual review, custodial risk, and fee levels that sit close to letter of credit fees. Blockmediary is positioned as the synthesis neither camp has reached. The absence of a lead investor and the wider problem of consortium governance is a proven failure mode rather than a hypothetical risk, evidenced directly by Contour's own account of its shutdown, and this is usable evidence that bank led blockchain trade finance struggles structurally to move quickly, in a way a focused, non bank owned product does not. Custody and verification are the two axes that most cleanly separate every researched competitor from Blockmediary, since no researched competitor is both non custodial and rules based document verified at the same time, which is why the head to head comparison in section two is built around exactly those two dimensions. On fees specifically, Tazapay's zero point eight to three point eight per cent and Truzo's zero point two two to three point one per cent both land in or above the one to three per cent range typical of letter of credit fees. Blockmediary's tiered zero point eight, one point five and three per cent structure undercuts that range on Tier A and matches it on Tier B and Tier C, with a blended take rate starting near two per cent in Year one and falling toward one per cent by Year five as Tier A adoption grows, a useful side by side statistic for a pitch slide, now grounded in the deal value research report and financial model rather than an aspirational close to zero per cent claim. Finally, a caveat should be stated explicitly rather than omitted from the individual report: several of the platforms compared here, particularly Komgo and XREX, are larger, regulated, and well funded incumbents, and Blockmediary's honest counter to that scale is speed of trust, meaning rules based verification measured in minutes rather than bank underwriting measured in days, and cost, meaning the absence of a bank margin, rather than a claim to greater scale or regulatory maturity. Artificial intelligence extraction and a human review console remain on the roadmap rather than delivered, which is itself a gap worth acknowledging directly in the reflection section of the individual report, alongside the scale and regulatory maturity points.

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